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BY

**RUDYARD
KIPLING.**

**An Almanac
of twelve Sports
by William Nicholson**

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK AN ALMANAC
OF TWELVE SPORTS ***

**An Almanac
of twelve Sports**

By William Nicholson

*Words by
Rudyard Kipling*

Published by R. H. Russell. New York.
1898.

1898.

January.

Sunday 2 9 16 23 30
Monday 3 10 17 24 31
Tuesday 4 11 18 25 —
Wednesday 5 12 19 26 —
Thursday 6 13 20 27 —
Friday 7 14 21 28 —
Saturday 18 15 22 29 —

February.

Sunday 6 13 20 27
Monday 7 14 21 28
Tuesday 18 15 22 —
Wednesday 29 16 23 —
Thursday 3 10 17 24 —
Friday 4 11 18 25 —
Saturday 5 12 19 26 —

March.

May.

April.

<i>Sunday</i> 6 13 20 27	<i>Sunday</i> 18 15 22 29	<i>Sunday</i> 3 10 17 24
<i>Monday</i> 7 14 21 28	<i>Monday</i> 29 16 23 30	<i>Monday</i> 4 11 18 25
<i>Tuesday</i> 18 15 22 29	<i>Tuesday</i> 3 10 17 24 31	<i>Tuesday</i> 5 12 19 26
<i>Wednesday</i> 29 16 23 30	<i>Wednesday</i> 4 11 18 25 —	<i>Wednesday</i> 6 13 20 27
<i>Thursday</i> 3 10 17 24 31	<i>Thursday</i> 5 12 19 26 —	<i>Thursday</i> 7 14 21 28
<i>Friday</i> 4 11 18 25 —	<i>Friday</i> 6 13 20 27 —	<i>Friday</i> 18 15 22 29
<i>Saturday</i> 5 12 19 26 —	<i>Saturday</i> 7 14 21 28 —	<i>Saturday</i> 29 16 23 30

June.

Sunday 5 12 19 26

<i>Monday</i>	6	132027
<i>Tuesday</i>	7	142128
<i>Wednesday</i>	18	152229
<i>Thursday</i>	29	162330
<i>Friday</i>	310	1724—
<i>Saturday</i>	411	1825—

Here is a horse to tame—
Here is a gun to handle—
God knows you can enter the game
If you'll only pay for the same,
And the price of the game is a candle—
One single flickering candle!

1898.

July.

<i>Sunday</i>	3 10 17 24 31
<i>Monday</i>	4 11 18 25 —
<i>Tuesday</i>	5 12 19 26 —
<i>Wednesday</i>	6 13 20 27 —
<i>Thursday</i>	7 14 21 28 —
<i>Friday</i>	1 8 15 22 29 —
<i>Saturday</i>	2 9 16 23 30 —

August.

<i>Sunday</i>	7 14 21 28
<i>Monday</i>	1 8 15 22 29
<i>Tuesday</i>	2 9 16 23 30
<i>Wednesday</i>	3 10 17 24 31
<i>Thursday</i>	4 11 18 25 —
<i>Friday</i>	5 12 19 26 —
<i>Saturday</i>	6 13 20 27 —

September.

<i>Sunday</i>	4 11 18 25
<i>Monday</i>	5 12 19 26
<i>Tuesday</i>	6 13 20 27
<i>Wednesday</i>	7 14 21 28
<i>Thursday</i>	1 8 15 22 29
<i>Friday</i>	2 9 16 23 30
<i>Saturday</i>	3 10 17 24 —

October.

<i>Sunday</i>	2 9 16 23 30
<i>Monday</i>	3 10 17 24 31
<i>Tuesday</i>	4 11 18 25 —
<i>Wednesday</i>	5 12 19 26 —
<i>Thursday</i>	6 13 20 27 —
<i>Friday</i>	7 14 21 28 —
<i>Saturday</i>	1 8 15 22 29 —

November.

December.

Sunday 6132027
Monday 7142128
Tuesday 1 8152229
Wednesday 2 9162330
Thursday 3101724—
Friday 4111825—
Saturday 5121926—

Sunday 4111825
Monday 5121926
Tuesday 6132027
Wednesday 7142128
Thursday 1 8152229
Friday 2 9162330
Saturday 310172431

Hunting.

Certes it is a noble sport
And men have quitted selle and swum
for't,
But I am of a meeker sort
And I prefer Surtees in comfort.

Reach down my "Handley Cross" again.
My run, where never danger lurks, is
With Jorrocks and his deathless train
Pigg, Binjamin and Arterxerxes!



January.

Coursing.

Most men harry the world for fun—
Each man seeks it a different way
But "of all daft devils under the sun
A grey'ound's the daftest" said Jorrocks J.



February.

Racing.

The horse is ridden—the jockey rides—
The backers back—the owners own
But ... there are lots of things besides,
And I should leave this play alone.



March.

Boating.

The Pope of Rome he could not win
From pleasant meat and pleasant sin
These who, in honour's hope, endure
Lean days and lives enforced pure.
These who, replying not, submit
Unto the curses of the Pit
Which he that rides (O greater
shame!)
Flings forth by number not by
name...
Could Triple Crown or Jesuit's oath
Do what yon shuffle-stockings doth?



April.

Fishing.

Behold a parable! *A* fished for *B*.
C took her bait; her heart was set on *D*.
Thank Heaven, who cooled your blood and
 cramped your wishes,
Men and not Gods torment you, little fishes.



May.

Cricket.

Thank God who made the British Isles
And taught me how to play,
I do not worship crocodiles
Or bow the knee to clay!

Give me a willow wand and I,
With hide and cork and twine,
From century to century
Will gambol round my Shrine.



June.

Archery.

The child of the Nineties considers with laughter
The maid whom his Sire in the sixties ran after,
While careering himself in pursuit of a girl whom
The Twenties will dub a "last century heir-loom."



July.

Coaching.

The Pious Horse to church may trot.
A maid may work a man's salvation.
Four horses and a girl are not,
However, aids to reformation.



August.

Shooting.

"Peace upon Earth, Goodwill to
men!"

So greet we Christmas Day.
Oh Christian load your gun and then,
O Christian, out and slay!



September.

Golf.

Why Golf is Art and Art is Golf
we have not far to seek—
So much depends upon the lie,
so much upon the cleek.

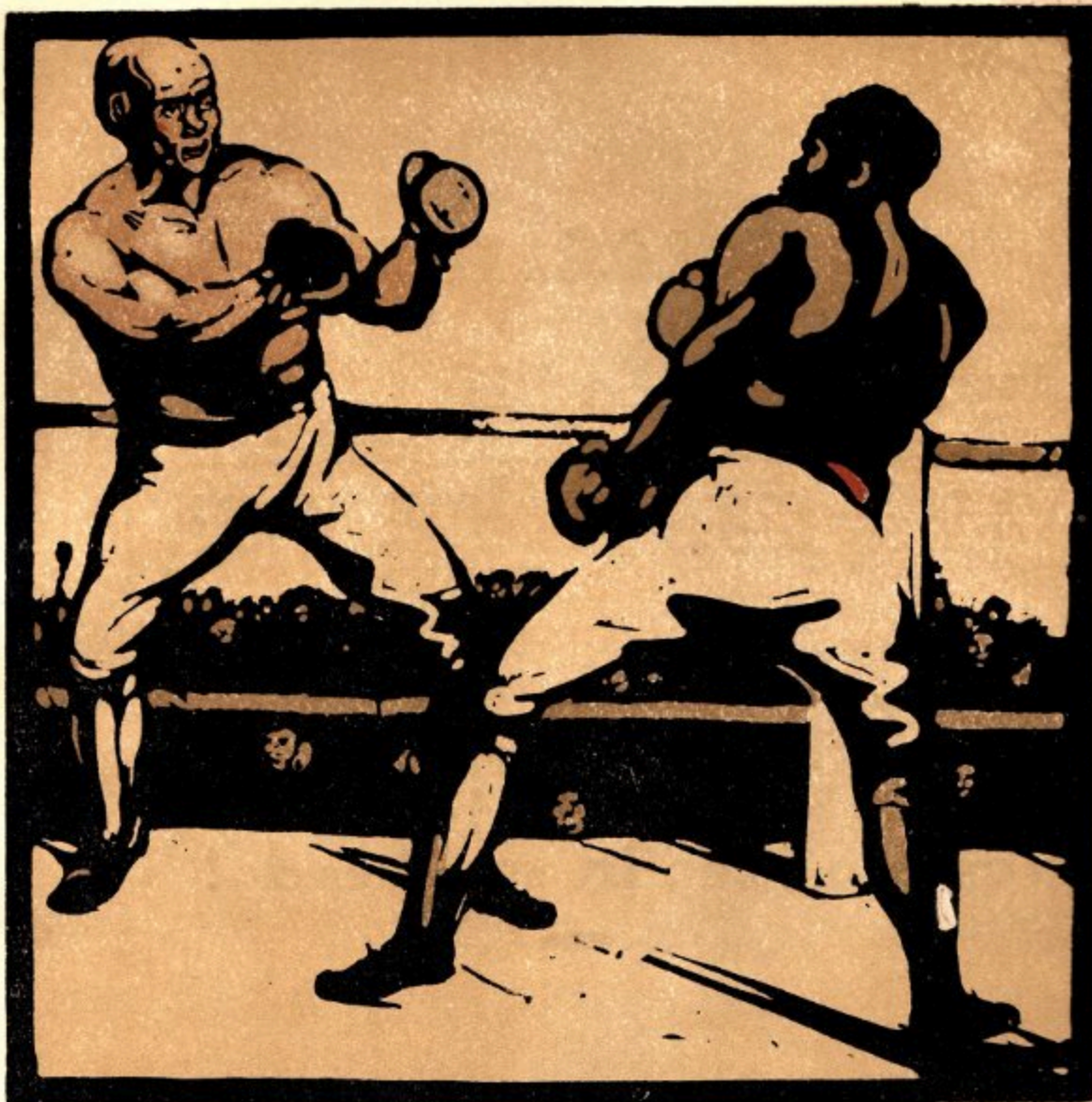


October.

Boxing.

Read here the Moral roundly writ
For him that into battle goes—
Each soul that, hitting hard and hit,
Encounters gross or ghostly foes:—
Prince, blown by many overthrows
Half blind with shame, half choked with
dirt

*Man cannot tell but Allah knows
How much the other side was hurt!*



November.

Skating.

Over the ice she flies
Perfect and poised and fair—
Stars in my true-love's eyes
Teach me to do and to dare!

Now will I fly as she flies ...
Woe for the stars that misled!
Stars that I saw in her eyes
Now do I see in my head!



December.

Now we must come away.

What are you out of pocket?
'Sorry to spoil your play,
But Somebody says we must pay—
And the candle's down to the socket—
 Its horrible tallowy socket!

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK AN ALMANAC OF
TWELVE SPORTS ***

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